



Lock with Style!

Feeling too lazy to get up and open your door? Here's how to make it easy.
<http://dgit.in/S-lock>



WatchDogs...in Reality

These hackers control a car...with the driver inside. Watch here:
<http://dgit.in/remotedriver>

Smartbands ahoy!

Agent001 needs to lose a few kilos and this is how he went about it

Agent 001

agent001@digit.in

This might not be a surprise to many but somewhere down the line I started slipping... I knew I should have kept the extra plate of jalebis aside, but they were so darn juicy! Needless to say, some might be of the opinion that I've pigeonholed myself into one of the nerd stereotypes. That is, I'm bitching about having gained a little too much weight. Perhaps I'm at that point where my metabolism isn't what it used to be. Eating with reckless abandon has finally caught up with me and I can feel it in my knees when I climb a few flights of stairs or burst into a sprint to catch the train. But I've decided to avoid waiting until the New Year's eve to come up with a weightloss resolution. The time for action is nigh my friends, and technology shall aid me in my battle against fat globules!

Thus began my search for apps and gadgets to help me get back on track. I'm not one to have an app for everything, so no, there won't be one for running, another one for swimming and yet another for cycling. I prefer to keep my phone clutter-free and if that means I have to compromise on certain features or aspects, then so be it. Now everyone is wired differently and this makes one particular form of exercise seem better than the rest. For me, it's running. I know there are a lot of other ways I can burn more calories and that too quicker but I'd like to get up in the morning on the next day and get to work. This is why I went with running. It's convenient, in the sense that I don't have to get to a gym/pool/track to exercise.

After a brief amount of Googling, like every other noob, I felt that I'd learnt everything there is about running. So on Day 1, I took to the streets with a pair of headphones



and my mobile with GPS switched on. My approach was to not install any apps or buy a new gadget whatsoever since I had a perfectly capable phone. By charting out my route on Google Maps, I could easily run simple calculations and figure out the efficiency of the workout. This went for a few days but after a near death experience thanks to running along the roads with ear-phones plugged in, I ditched them. So music is out of the question, it's perfectly fine when you're indoors running on the treadmill but like I said earlier, I'd like to get up and go to work, and staying alive is apparently important for that to work.

Over the course of one week, running with my phone started to feel a bit weird, the extra weight is one thing but when you're running wearing loose clothes, the phone can swing...like really swing. My phone is only about 180-190 grammes but the swinging action can give it quite a bit of momentum and no grown man wants anything heavy swingily violently close to... the family jewels. Sorry for painting a nasty picture in your mind, but that's how it is and at this point in time my choices were to either get an elastic arm band for the phone or invest in a smart band. The prospect of

buying a new gadget got me all excited so I went for the latter option. The market is full of these wearables and some of them are really blurring the lines separating them. I'm not going to bother with a huge chapter on Technological Convergence here. Among these wearables, some were Smart Watches like the Garmin Vivoactive or the Fitbit Surge, and then there were waterproof bands like the Garmin Swim which would have interested me had I picked swimming over running. I noticed that I was veering towards bands that appeared inconspicuous like the Xiaomi Mi Band and the Jawbone UP3. And all these were just the tip of the iceberg. It slowly started getting a little overwhelming and I broke out the spreadsheet to start off a comparison. As I was reading up on smart bands, Jayesh happened to pass by my station and pointed out that he'd been looking at smart bands and had already shortlisted a few. He had a Fitbit Charge HR lying around which he graciously let me borrow. Needless to say, I trust his judgement and went with the Fitbit Charge HR. It isn't huge, doesn't look like a fat watch and isn't too flashy. The minimalist design was a welcome feature, though the display felt a little drab. But then again, I run in the early morning before the sun's up so it's sufficient. The heart-rate readings are something I'd ignore, it's data that can be put to use for those who have certain health conditions but these smart bands aren't medically certified to monitor heart-rate so I'd take those readings with a pinch of salt. If you want something to be accurate, you need to calibrate it yourself. So I marked out a few stretches along known roads and went about counting steps/distance in meters. Soon enough, I had a spreadsheet with calibration data, which painted a more accurate picture.

Needless to say, at the end of all this, I've spent more time in front of my computer tinkering with the API and the smart band rather than slapping it onto my wrist and going for a jog. Well, anything for the love of technology. 🇮🇳